AI-Assisted Development — Interview Prep Course

AI-Assisted Development — Interview Prep Course

> **A 6-chapter course for engineers who use AI tools daily and need to defend their craft in interviews.** This is the answer to the question every hiring manager is asking in 2026: *"Why should I still hire human developers?"*

Who this course is for

You. Specifically, you are:

- A developer who uses Cascade, Cursor, Copilot, ChatGPT, Claude, or any other AI coding assistant *every day*.
- About to interview for a software role — junior, mid, senior, staff.
- Worried that "vibe coding" will be held against you, *or* that you'll be asked questions about AI you can't answer.
- Tired of LinkedIn takes and want a focused, practical, interview-grade resource.

This course is **not** a how-to-prompt tutorial. There are dozens of those. This is **interview prep**: how to talk about AI-assisted development with the depth and nuance that gets you hired over the candidate next to you.

What this course teaches

By the time you finish:

1. You'll be able to **answer "why do we still need human developers?"** with a confident, multi-layered response that lasts 90 seconds and lands every time.

2. You'll have **18 prepared answers** to the most common AI-related interview questions of 2026.
3. You'll know how to **survive a live coding interview that uses AI** — both the "build it with the AI" format and the "debug what the AI built" format.
4. You'll have a **prompt library** you can deploy in any interview that asks you to *demonstrate* your AI workflow.
5. You'll understand the **risks, ethics, and accountability** questions deeply enough to answer the "what about hallucinations? IP? security?" follow-ups without flinching.
6. You'll have a **portfolio narrative** that frames AI use as an *asset*, not a crutch.

Why this course exists

Every senior interviewer I've talked to in the last 12 months says the same thing:

> *"Candidates who use AI well are easy to spot. So are candidates who use it badly. The hard ones are candidates who use it badly but* ***think they use it well****. Those are the hires we regret."*

This course makes you the first kind. It does it by forcing you to articulate, in plain English, the things you already do unconsciously when AI assists you well — and by sharpening the things you do unconsciously when it assists you badly.

There are also questions you've probably never been asked but *will* be asked soon:

- *"If I gave you a $50,000 budget for AI tooling for your team, how would you spend it?"*
- *"Tell me about a time AI gave you wrong code. What did you do?"*
- *"Why shouldn't I just hire a junior developer with Claude Code instead of you?"*
- *"How do you evaluate the quality of AI-generated code in code review?"*
- *"What's a problem you would* not *trust AI to solve, and why?"*

You can't wing those. You can rehearse them.

Course structure

```
ai-interview-course/
│
```

```
├── README.md                                ← YOU ARE HERE
│
├── chapter-01-foundations/                        ← THE MODERN AI-
ASSISTED ENGINEER
│    ├── README.md
│   ├── 01-what-changed.md            The 2026 baseline: what every dev does no
│   ├── 02-the-skill-stack.md          What's still yours, what's the AI's
│     └── 03-the-mindset-shift.md                       From "code-
typist" to "engineering judgment owner"
│
├── chapter-02-the-big-question/         ← "WHY DO WE STILL NEED HUMANS?"
│    ├── README.md
│   ├── 01-the-five-framings.md         The 5 ways this question is asked
│   ├── 02-the-seven-pillars.md         The complete answer framework
│   └── 03-real-world-cases.md          Stories where humans saved the day
│
├── chapter-03-prompt-mastery/                              ← VIBE-
CODING FOR INTERVIEWS
│    ├── README.md
│   ├── 01-anatomy-of-a-prompt.md       The structure of a prompt that ships
│   ├── 02-the-twelve-patterns.md       12 reusable prompt templates
│   └── 03-rejecting-ai-output.md       When to push back, rewrite, or throw it
│
├── chapter-04-live-scenarios/          ← THE REAL INTERVIEW EXERCISES
│    ├── README.md
│   ├── 01-live-pair-programming.md      The "build it with AI in front of me" f
│    ├── 02-debugging-ai-bugs.md                 The "debug this AI-
generated code" exercise
│   └── 03-code-review-of-ai.md         Reviewing AI output as a senior enginee
│
├── chapter-05-system-design/                ← ARCHITECTURE WITH AI
│    ├── README.md
│   ├── 01-what-humans-still-own.md      The architecture decisions AI cannot m
│   ├── 02-design-with-ai-walkthrough.md    "Design Twitter with AI assistance"
fully worked
│     └── 03-trade-off-conversations.md            Talking trade-
```

```
offs in front of a panel
│
└── chapter-06-behavioral-and-closing/      ← BEHAVIORAL & CLOSING
     ├── README.md
   ├── 01-risks-and-accountability.md     Hallucinations, security, IP, accoun
   ├── 02-team-dynamics.md            How AI changes pair programming, code rev
        └──  03-portfolio-narrative.md                       Your  AI-
assisted story + Q&A mastery
```

18 lessons. ~25 hours of focused study. Designed to be finished in 2 weeks before an interview round.

How to use this course

The 14-day plan (recommended)

Day	What
1	Chapter 1 (foundations) — read all 3 lessons
2	Chapter 2 lesson 1 (the 5 framings) — memorize the framings
3	Chapter 2 lessons 2 & 3 (the 7 pillars + cases) — rehearse the pillar answer aloud 3×
4	Chapter 3 lesson 1 (anatomy of a prompt)
5	Chapter 3 lesson 2 (12 patterns) — copy patterns to a personal notes file
6	Chapter 3 lesson 3 (rejecting AI output)
7	**Mid-course rehearsal day**: do the 90-second pitch + 5 random questions out loud
8	Chapter 4 lesson 1 (live pair programming) — practice with a real prompt session
9	Chapter 4 lessons 2 & 3 (debug + code review) — work through the exercises
10	Chapter 5 lessons 1 & 2 (architecture + design walkthrough)
11	Chapter 5 lesson 3 (trade-off conversations)

Day	What
12	Chapter 6 lessons 1 & 2 (risks + team dynamics)
13	Chapter 6 lesson 3 (portfolio + Q&A) — write your answers to all 18 questions
14	**Full mock interview**: 60 minutes, friend asks the questions, you answer cold

The "I have an interview tomorrow" plan

Read in this order:

1. `chapter-02-the-big-question/02-the-seven-pillars.md` — memorize the framework.
2. `chapter-06-behavioral-and-closing/03-portfolio-narrative.md` — get your story tight.
3. `chapter-04-live-scenarios/01-live-pair-programming.md` — know what to expect.
4. `chapter-03-prompt-mastery/02-the-twelve-patterns.md` — skim the patterns.

That's ~3 hours of focused reading. Sleep on it. You'll be 80% ready.

What you bring to this course

- You write code regularly (any language; examples lean React/TypeScript but the lessons are language-agnostic).
- You've used at least one AI coding tool seriously for ≥ 3 months.
- You can articulate, however roughly, what you used AI for last week.
- You're willing to **say things out loud**. This is interview prep. Reading silently is not enough.

What you do *not* need

- A degree in ML.

- An understanding of how transformers work internally.
- Experience with multiple AI tools (one is enough).
- A finished project. We'll reference one fantasy snooker app throughout, but every example is portable.

The promise

If you complete this course and rehearse the answers, you will:

- Walk into your next interview with **zero anxiety** about the AI questions.
- Be able to **defend AI-assisted code** as professionally as any senior reviewer would.
- Have **a clear, honest, optimistic answer** to "why are you still relevant?" — one that isn't dismissive, defensive, or cocky.
- Hand interviewers a **memorable narrative** about you and AI tools that they'll repeat to the hiring committee.

That last one is the whole game. You don't need to be the best engineer in the room. You need to be the one the panel **remembers favorably**. This course is built around that.

A note on the worry behind this question

You're probably reading this because, somewhere in the back of your head, there's a quiet worry: *"What if AI does replace developers? What if I'm prepping for a job that won't exist in 5 years?"*

We address that worry head-on in **Chapter 2 Lesson 2**. The short version: the role *changes*, but the person who can *judge* code, *own* outcomes, *negotiate* trade-offs, and *unblock* a team will always be more valuable than a tool that produces text. AI raises the floor of what's possible — it does not raise the ceiling of what's required.

Your job is to be measurably above the floor. This course teaches you how to *show* that you are.

Start here

Open `chapter-01-foundations/README.md`.

You won't write a single line of code in Chapter 1. You'll write *answers*. Bring a notebook.